

GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT

Put the Fries in the Bag

A post-apocalyptic cooperative fast-food horror

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Game Summary

Put the Fries in the Bag is a cooperative fast-food horror game set after the apocalypse. Up to four players control small, hovering robot employees running a badly deteriorated restaurant for mutated human customers and a similarly mutated owner. The robots prepare food and meet a profit quota each shift, switching into a compact wheel mode to hide and travel through ventilation shafts when needed. If the shift quota is missed, the owner enters a timed rage phase and hunts employees, damaging equipment as he pursues them. Survivors return for the next shift, where repairs and higher quotas make the job harder.

Game Design Pillars

Cooperative chaos. Players divide tasks like cooking, serving, and maintenance as orders pile up. Communication and quick changes in responsibility create funny, unpredictable moments.

Comedy with consequences. A ridiculous fast-food job in a decaying, mutant-filled world turns frightening after a failed quota. The shift from hectic service to a timed hunt creates contrast between absurd comedy and horror.

Every shift matters. The team chooses how to spend its earnings, while failed shifts can leave equipment damaged or destroyed. Those consequences carry into the next shift and change how players approach the kitchen.

User Experiences

The intended audience is players who enjoy cooperative games, cooking-management challenges, and survival horror with dark humor. The game is highly inspired by the likes of Lethal Company and REPO. The game should give friends stories to tell: a floating robot struggling with a rush of orders from revolting mutant customers, a last-second quota, or a panicked escape through a vent while the owner wrecks the kitchen. Players should feel that teamwork improves their chances, even when everything goes wrong.

Core Gameplay

Aim of the Game

The objective is to complete as many shifts as possible by preparing orders for mutated patrons and meeting each shift's profit quota. During service, hovering robot employees cook, package, and deliver food while managing customer patience and equipment. Meeting the quota advances the team. Missing it starts a timed hunt: the robots can lower into wheel mode to hide and enter vents, or evade the owner elsewhere in the restaurant until the timer expires. Caught employees spectate for the rest of the shift and return next shift if anyone survives. Equipment damage caused by the owner carries forward and costs money to fix. The game also offers money/economy management by allowing players to purchase and upgrade equipment to assist with shift quota times.

Game Design Goals

Clear cooperative roles. Allow employees to move between cooking, packing, serving, and equipment tasks instead of locking them into classes.

Readable, escalating pressure. Increase demand through busier orders from mutated patrons and higher quotas without making the kitchen too complicated to understand.

Meaningful failure. Make the owner dangerous while ensuring his destruction affects the following shift through repair costs and lost equipment.

Replayable single location. Use changing orders, the robots' hover and wheel modes, team decisions, upgrades, and persistent damage to keep the same ruined restaurant engaging across shifts.

Approachable presentation. Use clear interactions and an easily readable interface so the challenge comes from coordination and pressure rather than confusing controls.

Features

Restaurant operation. Grotesquely mutated human customers place orders. Robot employees use aging grills, fryers, and preparation stations; undercooked, correct, or burnt food affects order quality and earnings.

Quota and spending. Each shift has a financial target. Players use their remaining money to purchase ingredients, repair equipment, replace destroyed machines, or invest in improvements. Exact prices and quota values will be set during balancing.

Timed owner hunt. A failed quota triggers a survival phase. The mutated owner uses sight and sound to hunt employees and breaks equipment or obstacles in his path. Robots can use wheel mode and ventilation shafts to hide or get away.

Persistent equipment condition. Kitchen equipment can remain operational, become damaged and less efficient, or be completely destroyed. Its condition carries forward until the team spends money to fix it.

Cooperative play. Up to four hovering robots share responsibilities. Caught players spectate for the rest of the failed shift and return next shift if at least one robot survives.

Player Mechanics

Players control small robots that normally hover around the restaurant, carry ingredients, use cooking stations, and deliver orders. They can lower into a compact, wheeled mode to move near the floor, slip into vents, and hide during the owner’s hunt. Robots can also evade the owner by breaking line of sight and using hiding spots. A first-person view and keyboard-and-mouse controls are proposed; precise bindings remain subject to playtesting.

Action	Proposed control / feedback
Move / look	WASD / mouse; movement and camera respond immediately.
Hover / wheel mode	Normal hover movement; Ctrl lowers the robot onto its wheels for vents and hiding.
Interact / carry	E; highlight usable objects and show an interaction prompt.
Use / drop held item	Left mouse button / G; clear pickup and placement feedback.
Cook / serve	Interact with a station, monitor food state, and deliver assembled orders.
Vent / hide	Enter vents and low hiding spots in wheel mode; hear cues when the owner is close.

Planned accessibility: remappable controls, readable order text and icons, and distinct visual and audio warnings.

Game World

The game takes place after an unspecified apocalypse, entirely inside a badly deteriorated fast-food restaurant that is somehow still operating. Rusted appliances, peeling surfaces, flickering signs, grime, makeshift repairs, and boarded windows show a world that has fallen apart. Its counter and dining area serve mutated human patrons; the kitchen, freezer, storage rooms, employee spaces, and ventilation shafts support both food preparation and survival. The cause of the apocalypse and mutations is deliberately left undefined at this stage.

During service, battered neon and surviving overhead lights reveal a busy but filthy kitchen. The grotesque customers make routine orders feel absurd and unsettling. After a failed quota, lights flicker or fail and sound shifts toward horror as the owner enters. Players interact with doors, ingredients, machines, vents, and hiding places. Repairs, upgrades, and destruction change the condition of the same restaurant over time.

Characters

Employees (playable). One to four small, box-shaped robots operate the restaurant without fixed classes. They float while working, then lower onto wheels in a compact wheel mode to hide and travel through vents. Their simple silhouettes contrast with the grotesque people they serve; final colors and customization are not yet decided.

The owner / manager (antagonist). A grotesquely mutated human who runs the restaurant and demands ever-higher profits. Mostly felt through his quota during service, he personally hunts the robots when they fail. His exact mutation, clothing, voice, and backstory are not yet finalized.

Customers (supporting NPCs). Disgusting, visibly mutated humans still visit the decaying restaurant for fast food. Their distorted appearances and unpleasant mannerisms supply dark humor, but they function as ordinary customers: they order, wait, and react to service. Individual designs and dialogue remain open.

Enemy

The mutated owner is the only planned enemy. He becomes hostile only after the team fails its quota. During the timed rage phase, he searches the ruined restaurant, reacts to movement and noise, and pursues detected robots. If he loses a target, he investigates its last known location. He does not seek out machinery to destroy; damage occurs as he smashes equipment and obstacles in his path during pursuit.

Robots survive through movement, hiding, and switching into wheel mode to enter vents, rather than combat. Heavy footsteps, crashes, and changes in lighting or music signal the owner's presence. A caught employee is eliminated for the rest of the shift and spectates. Surviving until the timer expires advances the team; captured employees return next shift. Hunt duration and detection difficulty can increase later. The outcome of a full-team elimination remains undecided.

Levels

There is one level: the derelict post-apocalyptic restaurant. The counter and dining area handle mutant customers; the battered kitchen and storage rooms support food preparation; employee spaces, low hiding spots, and ventilation shafts offer survival routes for robots in wheel mode. The owner's chase uses this same layout, with equipment destruction leaving persistent damage. Players return each shift; progression comes from rising quotas, order volume, repairs, and upgrades rather than new maps.

User Interface

Worn fast-food point-of-sale graphics show quota, earnings, shift time, orders, cooking progress, interaction prompts, and the robot's hover/wheel mode. During a hunt, order information gives way to a clear survival timer and warning. Eliminated players see a spectator view.

The main menu offers play, join, and settings. Between shifts, players review earnings, quota, equipment condition, and repairs.

Player Experience

Hovering robots perform an ordinary job for repulsive mutated customers in a ruined world. Rising order pressure rewards communication. Meeting the quota brings relief; missing it abruptly triggers the mutated owner's frightening hunt.

The same restaurant feels different across both phases. Faded neon, order chimes, clattering equipment, and grotesque patrons create uneasy comedy during service. Flickering lights, pounding footsteps, and crashes create fear during a hunt. Robots drop into wheel mode and disappear into vents to survive. Survivors repair the wrecked kitchen and try again; variable orders and damage keep shifts unpredictable.